Advantages:

- In a short span of time, vast geographical area can be covered.
- It involves less labor.

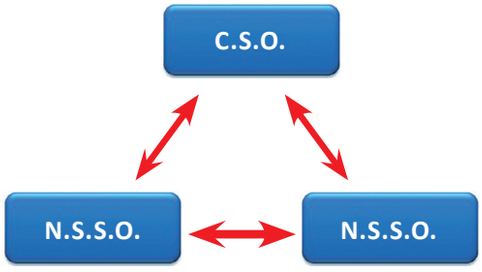
Limitations:

- This method can be used only for the literate population.
- Some of the mailed questionnaires may not be returned.
- Some of the filled questionnaires may not be complete.
- The success of this method depends on the nature of the questions and the involvement of the respondents.

Schedule:

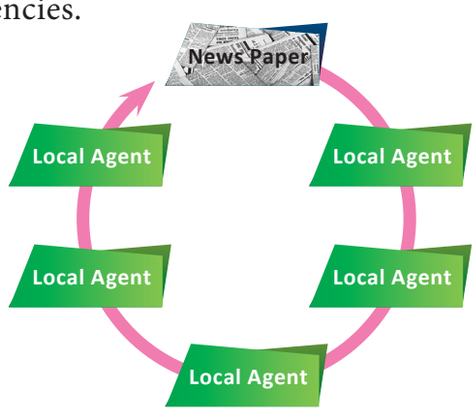
Schedule is a structure of a set of questions on a given topic which are asked by an investigator. Population census and some personal interview method are the examples of using schedules.

2.2.4 Local Correspondents Method



In this method, the investigator appoints local agents or correspondents in different places. They collect the information on behalf of the investigator in their locality and transmit the data to the investigator or headquarters. This method is adopted by newspapers and government agencies.

For instance, the Central Statistical Organization (CSO) of Government of India has local correspondents NSSO. Through them they get the required data. Newspaper publishers appoint agents to collect news for their dailies. These people collect data in their locality on behalf of the publisher and transmit them to the head office.



This method is economical and provides timely information on a continuous basis. It involves high degree of personal bias of the correspondents.

2.2.5 Enumeration method:

In this method, the trained enumerators or interviewers take the schedules themselves, contact the informants, get replies and fill them in their own hand writing.

Ch2_11th Stats.indd 22 2/3/2019 10:57:31 AM